

Research Title: When Deepfakes Became Fun: From Ghibli to Grok—How Online AI Trends Paved The Way For Nudification Abuse

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Introduction:

AI generated pictures have been a niche entertainment among the young generation ever since its debut. A significant evolution can be seen, from flawed early attempts to perfectly indistinguishable photorealistic images that can easily cause confusion leading to the question “Real or AI?”. Viral online trends like—Ghibli style animated portrait, fantasy photo edits and Gemini’s hyper-realistic image generation have made these perfect AI faces widely accessible and entertaining to the users. Seeing an unrealistic version of oneself is certainly quite entertaining. Millions have uploaded their photos, finding the results amusing and satisfactory then proceeding to showcase them in social media which encourages other individuals in doing so. However, people fail to realise that the same technology offering this amusement possesses a potential danger of “Nudification Abuse” through their uploaded images. Nudification AI tools such as “Grok” can be used to non-consensually undress anyone or create a fake intimate image of an individual using faces that predominantly target women and underage girls. Researchers term this AIG-NCII (AI generated non-consensual intimate imagery), a severe form of image-based sexual abuse. A recent CCDH audit found that approximately 65% of images generated by Grok on X depicted sexualised content, with 0.5% appearing to depict children. While studies have documented these harms, no research connects them to the viral AI face trends that normalized perfect face generation and further contributed to nudification abuse to the vulnerable. This study addresses that through an in-depth case of viral AI trends from Ghibli to Grok.

Literature Review:

AI-generated imagery has rapidly evolved from flawed early attempts to photorealistic images indistinguishable from real photographs. Early models produced faces marked by visible artifacts that made them easily detectable, but advances in generative adversarial networks and diffusion models have eliminated these telltale signs [1]. This technical progression has fundamentally transformed what is possible in digital image creation.

